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Commercial Knowledge Test

The CDL knowledge test is conducted in order to determine whether the applicant possesses sufficient knowledge of both state and federal traffic laws and driving practices for the safe operation of a Commercial Motor Vehicle (CMV). The knowledge tests provide no assurance of technical skill to drive safely on the highway.



When an applicant is requesting a Commercial Knowledge Test for a HAZMAT endorsement, the driver must complete ELDT prior to the test being administered.

View policy [3.6.2 Commercial Driver License \(CDL\) Issuance](#) and the CDL Entry Level Driver Training topic > Entry Level Driver Training (ELDT) Check section to complete the ELDT Check.

The CDL Knowledge tests (including endorsement tests) are offered by the Division in both the English and Spanish languages.

Depending on the type of CDL test, a certain amount of questions need to be answered correctly. A score of 80% or higher is needed to successfully pass.

Type of CDL Test	Total # of Questions	# of Questions Allowed to be Missed
CDL General Knowledge	50	10
CDL Combination	20	4
CDL Air Brakes	25	5
CDL Passenger	20	4
CDL Hazardous Materials	30	6
CDL Tanker	20	4
CDL Doubles and Triples	20	4
School Bus	20	4

The CSR must question the applicant to determine the appropriate CDL knowledge test applicable to the request. The applicant must indicate:

- The class of license requesting
- The type of vehicle to be operated
- The type of cargo to be transported
- The gross vehicle weight rating (GVWR) of the vehicle(s)

Commercial Knowledge Test

The following customers are required to pass a CDL Knowledge Test prior to the issuance of a Class A, B, or C CDL or CLP:

- A customer whose Arizona CLP has expired
- A customer who is applying for a first time CDL or CLP
- A customer who is applying for a higher class CDL or CLP
- A customer whose Arizona or out-of-state CDL is expired, suspended, canceled, or revoked for more than 12 months
- A customer who holds an out-of-country CDL
- A customer who holds a CDL issued by a U.S. Military agency
- A customer who is adding a new endorsement to the Arizona CDL
- A customer who is renewing or transferring a Hazardous Materials Endorsements (HME)
- A customer who does not have a valid CDL in their possession or is unable to provide proof of a previous license

- A customer who previously passed the knowledge test but did not have the endorsement issued in the previous 12 months



A customer who is under the age of 18 is not eligible for a CDL/CLP and will not be given any CDL Knowledge Test.

A customer who is eligible for a CDL/CLP, but is under the age of 21 is not eligible for a HME and will not be given a HME Knowledge Test.

- ▶ **Types of Knowledge Tests Based on Class of CDL**
- ▶ **Initial CLP Class and Fees**
- ▶ **Endorsement Knowledge Tests and Fees**
- ▶ **Prior to Administering CDL Knowledge Test**
- ▶ **Administering the CDL Knowledge Test**
- ▶ **Applicant is Observed Cheating**
- ▶ **Failing CDL Knowledge Test**
- ▶ **Waiving CDL Knowledge Testing**

Policies

[3.1.5 Commercial Driver License \(CDL\) Medical Requirements](#)

[3.3.1 License/ Identification Application](#)

[3.6.1 Commercial Driver License \(CDL\) Eligibility Requirements](#)

[3.6.2 Commercial Driver License \(CDL\) Issuance](#)

[3.6.3 CDL Knowledge Test Requirements](#)

[3.8.1 Cancellations](#)

[7.1.5 CDLIS / SPEXS](#)

[7.1.7 PDPS](#)

Forms

[CDL Documentation Requirements, form #96-0526](#)

[AZ Commercial Driver License Hazardous Materials Manual, form #40-7802B](#)

[AZ Commercial Driver License Manual, form #40-7802](#)

[AZ Commercial Driver License School Bus Manual, form #40-7802C](#)

[Medical Examination Report \(MER\), form #MCSA-5875](#)

[Medical Examiner's Certificate \(MEC\), form #MCSA-5876](#)

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[Travel License/Identification Application, form #40-5122](#)

[Travel License/Identification Application \(Spanish\), form #40-5122s](#)

[Vision Examination Report, form #32-4001](#)

Websites

[FMCSA Registry](#)

HELPFUL LINKS

» [MVD / DMV Public Website](#) »

» [Customer Portal](#) »

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